

UX AUDIT · MAY 2026

Veridine Pharma Web Accessibility

A WCAG 2.1 Level AA review of
veridinepharma.com — patient and HCP
experiences.

PREPARED FOR VERIDINE DIGITAL · MAY 2026

AGENDA

What we'll cover

01 Scope & methodology
Pages, devices, assistive tech, and the standards we tested against.

03 Executive summary
Overall conformance score and severity breakdown.

05 Detail & evidence
The four issues most likely to block a user — and how we'd fix them.

02 Why WCAG matters for pharma
Regulatory exposure, ADA litigation trends, and patient reach.

04 Findings by WCAG principle
Perceivable · Operable · Understandable · Robust.

06 Prioritized roadmap
Now / Next / Later remediation plan with owners.

SECTION 01

Scope & methodology

WHAT WE TESTED

- **12 templates** across the patient site, HCP portal, and unbranded condition site
- Home, ISI, Important Safety Information modal, prescribing information PDF landing, savings card flow, and the HCP login
- Desktop (1440 px) and mobile (375 px) breakpoints
- Chrome, Safari, Firefox, and Edge — current stable

HOW WE TESTED

- **WCAG 2.1 Level AA** as the conformance target; Level AAA noted where relevant for pharma audiences
- Automated scans via axe DevTools and Lighthouse
- Manual keyboard-only navigation of every flow
- Screen reader pass with VoiceOver (macOS / iOS) and NVDA (Windows)
- Color-contrast verification with APCA and traditional WCAG ratios

SECTION 02

Why this matters for pharma

Pharmaceutical web experiences sit at the intersection of regulated content, sensitive audiences, and ADA exposure. Accessibility is not optional.

PATIENTS AFFECTED

1 in 4

U.S. adults live with a disability that can affect how they read, hear, or interact with a web page — many of them on therapy.

ADA WEB LAWSUITS FILED

+8,800

Title III digital accessibility cases filed in U.S. federal court in 2024 — pharma and healthcare among the top five targeted sectors.

ISI COMPLIANCE RISK

Direct

If Important Safety Information cannot be perceived by all users equally, prominence and balance obligations may be considered unmet.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Partial conformance, with critical blockers

OVERALL WCAG 2.1 AA SCORE

62_{/100}

47 distinct issues identified across 12 page templates. Six are user-blocking and must be resolved before the next campaign launch.

CRITICAL

6

Blocks task completion for assistive-tech users

SERIOUS

14

Significant degradation; workarounds required

MODERATE

19

Noticeable friction, inconsistent compliance

MINOR

8

Polish items and best-practice deviations

Issues across all four WCAG principles

PRINCIPLE 01

P

Perceivable

Information and UI components must be presented in ways users can perceive — including text alternatives and adequate contrast.

18 issues 3 critical

PRINCIPLE 02

O

Operable

All functionality must be available from a keyboard, with enough time and clear navigation, and without triggering seizures.

12 issues 2 critical

PRINCIPLE 03

U

Understandable

Text and the operation of the interface must be readable and predictable — especially around forms, errors, and clinical content.

10 issues 1 critical

PRINCIPLE 04

R

Robust

Content must work with current and future user agents, including assistive technologies — clean semantics and valid ARIA.

7 issues 0 critical

Color contrast fails across the ISI and CTA system

LOCATION	PAIRING	RATIO	REQUIRED	SEVERITY
Hero CTA — <code>.btn-primary</code>	 Lime on white	1.63 : 1	4.5 : 1	CRITICAL
ISI body — fixed footer drawer	 Slate on navy	2.91 : 1	4.5 : 1	CRITICAL
Form helper text — savings enrollment	 Gray on white	3.18 : 1	4.5 : 1	CRITICAL
Inline link in body copy	 Olive on white	4.21 : 1	4.5 : 1	SERIOUS
Focus ring on dark cards	 Lime on navy	2.7 : 1 (non-text)	3 : 1	SERIOUS

Recommendation — restrict the brand lime to large display type and accents only; introduce a darker accent (`#7A8500`) for interactive elements on light backgrounds, and re-tone ISI body copy to pure white.

Keyboard users cannot complete core flows

ISSUE 01 · CRITICAL

ISI drawer trap on mobile

The fixed ISI drawer captures focus when expanded but offers no way to dismiss or return to the page with a keyboard. Screen reader users on iOS are stranded.

#isi-drawer · expanded · no aria-modal · no Esc handler

ISSUE 02 · CRITICAL

Savings card flow skips a step

The eligibility question on step 2 is rendered as a styled `<div>` with a click handler. Tab order bypasses it; users complete the form without consenting.

ISSUE 03 · SERIOUS

Focus indicator is invisible

Default browser outline is suppressed globally with `outline: none` and no replacement style. Users tabbing through the page have no idea where they are.

ISSUE 04 · SERIOUS

No "skip to content" link

The site's primary nav contains 11 links. Keyboard and screen-reader users must traverse all of them on every page; a visible-on-focus skip link is missing.

Forms and error messaging

WHAT WE OBSERVED

- Input labels are visually present but implemented as adjacent text — not programmatically associated with the field.
- Required fields rely on a red asterisk alone; the requirement is never announced to assistive tech.
- Error states color the border red but do not move focus, scroll into view, or describe the error.
- The ISI modal opens with a generic `role="dialog"` and no accessible name or description.
- Date-of-birth field accepts a single text input — no format hint, no input mask, no parsing tolerance.

WHY IT MATTERS HERE

Savings card enrollment is the highest-converting moment on the site. Users who cannot complete the form are users who do not start therapy. This same form gates the patient support program.

Fix priority. A correctly-labelled form with descriptive, focus-receiving error messages would resolve four of the five findings on this slide and is recoverable in a single sprint.

Semantics and ARIA hygiene

ISSUE	WHERE IT APPEARS	SEVERITY	EFFORT
Heading hierarchy skips from H1 to H4	Condition overview, mechanism of action, dosing pages	SERIOUS	S — content templating
Decorative SVGs announced as images	Footer flourishes and hero shapes on 6 templates	MODERATE	XS — add aria-hidden
Custom toggle missing aria-pressed	Patient / HCP audience switch in primary nav	SERIOUS	S — component update
Live region not announced on form submit	Savings card and HCP rep-request forms	SERIOUS	M — needs SR testing
Duplicate landmark roles on home	Two <main> elements; three role="banner"	MODERATE	XS — markup cleanup

RECOMMENDATION

A 90-day path to AA conformance

Three waves of remediation. Wave one ships the critical fixes before the September brand campaign.

WAVE 01 · NOW

Days 0 — 30

CRITICAL

Re-tone CTAs, ISI body, and helper text to pass 4.5 : 1.

CRITICAL

Replace ISI drawer with a focus-managed dialog; add Esc + close button.

CRITICAL

Refactor savings-card consent step to a real `<button>`.

CRITICAL

Restore a visible 2 px focus ring across all interactive elements.

WAVE 02 · NEXT

Days 30 — 60

SERIOUS

Add a skip-to-content link and fix heading hierarchy in CMS templates.

SERIOUS

Programmatically associate every form label and add descriptive error messages.

SERIOUS

Audit and correct ARIA on the audience toggle, accordion, and tabs.

SERIOUS

Add live regions for form submission and ISI expansion events.

WAVE 03 · LATER

Days 60 — 90

MODERATE

Clean up landmark roles and decorative SVG announcements.

MODERATE

Document the accessible component patterns in the Veridine design system.

PROCESS

Add automated axe scans to CI; require manual SR pass at QA.

PROCESS

Publish an accessibility statement and feedback channel.



DISCUSSION · Q&A · NEXT STEPS

Thank you.

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